



First, Next, Then, Last

Quick facilitation notes & answer key

Goal

Students use the sequence words First, Next, Then, Last to order the steps of two everyday algorithms. Naming the order with sequence language is part of planning and representing a sequential algorithm (C3.1) and prepares students to describe how order affects the result (C3.2).

Ontario curriculum (Grade 1 — C3 Coding)

C3.1 — solve problems and create computational representations of mathematical situations by writing and executing code, including code that involves sequential events.

C3.2 — read and alter existing code, including code that involves sequential events, and describe how changes to the code affect the outcomes.

Materials

The printed worksheet and a pencil. Optional: four cards labelled First, Next, Then, Last to place beside the step-cards.

Run it (about 20 min)

1. I DO: read the order words. 'First we get the bread — you can't toast with no bread.' Place First on card B.
2. WE DO: Exercise 1 — label the toast cards First B, Next D, Then A, Last C. Exercise 2 — write B, D, A, C.
3. YOU DO: Exercise 3 — get ready for recess: coat, zip, hat, outside (B, A, D, C).
4. Connect: 'Order words help you plan the steps before you do them — that is what coders do.'

Answer key (modelled by the run-gate)

Ex 1 / Ex 2 — Make toast: First get the bread (B), Next put it in the toaster (D), Then push the lever down (A), Last take out the toast (C). Order: B, D, A, C.

Ex 3 — Get ready for recess: First put on your coat (B), Next zip it up (A), Then put on your hat (D), Last go outside (C). Order: B, A, D, C.

Why the order works: each step needs the one before — you zip AFTER the coat is on, and toast comes out AFTER it goes in. Swap two and the algorithm fails.

Watch for & differentiate

Common slip: ordering by card letters instead of by the task — the letters are just names.

Simplify: do the toast task only, acting out each step as you place an order word.

Extend: ask students to make up a 4-step task and label it with First, Next, Then, Last.

Success indicator: the child labels each card with the right order word and writes B, D, A, C and B, A, D, C.